



WILLIAM CAREY  
UNIVERSITY

---

SCHOOL *of* MUSIC

Music Handbook  
2026 - 2027

# Table of Contents

|                                                                             |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Section 1: Institutional Identity .....</b>                              | <b>1</b>  |
| - Introduction .....                                                        | 1         |
| - Mission Statement.....                                                    | 1         |
| - Vision Statement.....                                                     | 1         |
| <b>Section 2: Degree Programs .....</b>                                     | <b>2</b>  |
| - Undergraduate Degrees.....                                                | 2         |
| - Graduate Degrees .....                                                    | 3         |
| - Degree Plans .....                                                        | 3         |
| <b>Section 3: Admission &amp; Academic Benchmarks.....</b>                  | <b>4</b>  |
| - Admission to Music Curricula .....                                        | 4         |
| - Academic Advising & Registration.....                                     | 5         |
| - Upper-Level Examinations .....                                            | 5         |
| - Secondary Proficiency Examinations .....                                  | 6         |
| <b>Section 4: Performance Standards .....</b>                               | <b>7</b>  |
| - Applied Study .....                                                       | 7         |
| - Performance Attire .....                                                  | 7         |
| - Recital Class .....                                                       | 7         |
| - Jury Requirements .....                                                   | 9         |
| - Junior/Senior Recital Requirements.....                                   | 9         |
| - Colloquium .....                                                          | 10        |
| - Collaborative Piano Guidelines .....                                      | 10        |
| - Guest Artists .....                                                       | 11        |
| <b>Section 5: Piano Area Policies .....</b>                                 | <b>12</b> |
| - Class Piano.....                                                          | 12        |
| - Transfer Student Piano Policy .....                                       | 12        |
| - Piano Proficiency .....                                                   | 12        |
| - Piano Placement.....                                                      | 13        |
| <b>Section 6: Ensembles &amp; Performance Organizations .....</b>           | <b>15</b> |
| - Primary & Secondary Ensemble Requirements.....                            | 15        |
| - Ensemble Opportunities.....                                               | 15        |
| - Music Organizations.....                                                  | 17        |
| - Performance/Audition Opportunities.....                                   | 17        |
| <b>Section 7: Student Conduct, Attendance, &amp; General Policies .....</b> | <b>19</b> |
| - Class, Lesson, and Ensemble Attendance.....                               | 19        |
| - Facilities & Practice Room Access.....                                    | 19        |
| - Artificial Intelligence Policy.....                                       | 19        |
| - NAXOS .....                                                               | 19        |
| - Scholarship & Financial Aid .....                                         | 20        |

|                                                                 |    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>Section 8: Musician Health, Safety, &amp; Wellness</b> ..... | 21 |
| - Instrumental Injury Prevention & Resources .....              | 21 |
| - Vocal Injury Prevention & Resources .....                     | 23 |
| - Hearing Health & Noise Exposure Guidelines .....              | 25 |
| <br><b>Section 9: Faculty &amp; Staff Directory</b> .....       | 27 |
| - Leadership .....                                              | 27 |
| - Coordinators .....                                            | 27 |
| - Faculty .....                                                 | 28 |
| - Staff .....                                                   | 31 |
| - Graduate Assistants .....                                     | 31 |
| - Adjunct Faculty .....                                         | 31 |

# Section 1: Institutional Identity

## **INTRODUCTION**

---

The Winters School of Music at William Carey University is named in honor of Donald and Frances Winters in recognition of their vision, dedication, and leadership in developing the music program at the university. The Winters School has been an accredited institutional member of the National Association of Schools of Music (NASM) since 1966 and a member of the American Music Therapy Association (AMTA) since 1977.

## **MISSION STATEMENT**

---

The Winters School of Music prepares disciplined artists and practitioners for leadership and service through rigorous academic and performance training. We expect artistic excellence while equipping graduates to integrate faith with their vocational calling across diverse musical disciplines to the glory of God alone.

## **VISION STATEMENT**

---

*“One Goal, One Passion”*: Our *One Goal* is excellence in education and performance, and our *One Passion* is Jesus in worship and service.

## Section 2: Degree Programs

### DEGREE PROGRAMS

---

#### Undergraduate Degrees

##### Bachelor of Arts in Music

The Bachelor of Arts degree with a major in music is a more general, less specialized degree program. Students pursuing this degree must complete the music core, music major, and upper-level elective coursework. This study, coupled with an outside minor such as business, psychology, foreign language, or theatre, allows for a greater diversification of possible career choices.

##### Bachelor of Music with majors in the following areas:

###### Music Education

Certified by the Mississippi Department of Education, the music education program prepares teachers in choral, instrumental, and general music, K-12. The music education degree requires four years of course work and one semester of supervised teaching.

###### Performance

Performance degrees are offered in guitar, piano, and voice. Courses in literature, pedagogy, and applied lessons prepare the student for graduate study, performance, and teaching careers. Piano majors may also pursue an emphasis in pedagogy or collaborative performance. Voice majors may pursue an emphasis in pedagogy.

###### Music Therapy

The music therapy degree offers expertise in music and psychology that prepares the student for work in a clinical/hospital setting. This program requires four years of coursework that is followed by a six-month internship and leads to certification.

##### Bachelor of Science in Music with concentrations in the following areas:

###### Worship Leadership

Developed with today's full-time and bi-vocational worship leader in mind, this degree is designed with free electives to use for a minor or a second major. Courses include studies in music, worship studies, conducting, ensemble, and performance. The culmination of the degree is a worship leadership internship in the local church.

###### Worship Technology

Developed with today's full-time and bi-vocational worship technology director in mind, this degree is designed with free electives to use for a minor or a second major. Courses include studies in music, worship studies, technology, ensemble, and

performance. The culmination of the degree is a worship technology internship in the local church.

## Graduate Degrees

### Master of Music Education

The fully online Master of Music Education (M.M.E.) degree program provides an opportunity for music educators to perfect musicianship and enhance pedagogical expertise toward becoming master teachers. The program supports and advances the mission of William Carey University which is to provide quality liberal arts and professional education programs within a caring, Christian academic community, encouraging the individual student to develop his or her highest potential in scholarship, leadership, and service. Upon completion of this degree, students will be eligible for an advanced license (AA) to teach in the state of Mississippi.

### Master of Music in Worship Studies

The fully online Master of Music in Worship Studies (M.M.W.S.) degree program provides an opportunity for church music professionals to perfect musicianship and to enhance specific expertise in the fields of church music and worship studies. The program supports and advances the mission of William Carey University which is to provide quality liberal arts and professional education programs within a caring, Christian academic community, encouraging the individual student to develop his or her highest potential in scholarship, leadership, and service.

### Doctor of Arts in Music

The fully online Doctor of Arts in Music (D.A.) degree is designed to prepare musicians for careers in collegiate teaching as well as help prepare them to become leaders in their current positions as educators and worship leaders. The philosophy of the program is to integrate in-depth preparation in a primary emphasis, either Music Education or Worship Ministry, with general studies in an interest area that includes, but is not limited to, Conducting/ Performance Pedagogy, Leadership, Theology, and the Marching Arts. These interest areas are required to accommodate the diverse teaching responsibilities found in university instruction today. The School of Music core includes foundational course work in music history, music theory, and music performance.

**Comprehensive degree curricula can be found in the official University Catalog.**

## Section 3: Admission & Academic Benchmarks

### ADMISSION TO MUSIC CURRICULA

---

#### Undergraduate Admission

##### Music Audition

Prior to admission, each candidate should perform before the music faculty or program director. Selections should be representative of the student's highest level of proficiency in vocal or instrumental music. In some instances, a student may be admitted as a music major who has not had the formal training necessary to perform the suggested literature but demonstrates exceptional talent.

##### Music Theory Placement

A Music Theory Placement Exam will be given to all students entering the School of Music. All new students will enroll in Freshman Theory I, and based on the results of the placement exam, will attend class beginning in week 1 or week 9. If the student is a community college transfer student and completed 4 semesters of music theory (freshmen & sophomore levels) with a grade of B or higher, the placement exam is not required.

##### Transfer Credits

Evaluation of transfer credits for all courses, including music, is handled by the Registrar's Office. All keyboard placement, class sequence progression, transfer credit evaluations, and proficiency requirements are governed by the Piano Area Policies outlined in *Section 5* of this handbook. Transfer students must pass an upper-level examination during their first semester of attendance to continue in upper-level music study.

#### Graduate Admission

Master's degree candidates must hold a bachelor's degree in music from a regionally accredited institution with a cumulative grade point average of 2.75 over the last 60 credit hours of coursework

##### Music Education program requirements specific to M.M.E.

Prior to admission, students must complete an admission application and either possess a current teacher's certificate or have successfully passed Praxis II examinations (5113, 5114, 5115, or 5116) for teacher education eligibility (passing score based on state of residency).

##### Worship Studies program requirements specific to M.M.W.S.

Prior to admission, students must complete an admission application and submit an essay of no less than 500 words describing learning and professional goals.

Requirements for graduation are found in the graduate catalog.

## **Doctoral Admission**

Doctoral applicants must hold a master's degree in music (or equivalent) with a cumulative grade point average of 3.0 or higher on all master's level coursework. Applicants must submit two letters of recommendation from individuals familiar with the applicant's professional and/or educational work, a resume' (or curriculum vita), and a 1,000- to 1,500-word **scholarly** writing sample that describes the candidate's interest in pursuing a terminal degree and an issue related to the candidate's intended emphasis area. Accepted applicants must complete qualifying exams in music theory and music history.

Requirements for graduation are found in the graduate catalog.

## **ACADEMIC ADVISING & REGISTRATION**

---

Advising in the Winters School of Music ensures students progress through degree requirements in a timely manner, passing key benchmarks like Piano Proficiency and the Upper-Level Exam on schedule, and enrolling in the correct courses and ensembles.

Each student is assigned a faculty advisor within their major area to assist in mapping out music coursework and degree plans. Prior to the opening of registration, students should check their email for the official advising schedule and book an appointment with their assigned advisor. Students must arrive at advising appointments prepared with a completed Advising Sheet and a draft schedule. Both the student and advisor must sign the sheet before the registration hold is lifted. While faculty advisors provide guidance, tracking degree progress and catalog requirements remains the student's responsibility.

Registration access is determined by earned credit hours, check the university academic calendar for the appropriate registration window. Final drop/add deadlines also follow the university academic calendar. For system errors or repeated course registration, students must submit a request through the [WSOM Registration Assistance Form](#) for staff processing once advising clearance is verified.

## **UPPER-LEVEL EXAMINATIONS**

---

Upper-level coursework is designated by a course code in the 300-499 range. To determine eligibility for Upper-Level music study, all students should register for an examination in their applied concentration after the successful completion of Sophomore Theory (MUT 262) or Commercial Theory (MUT 265) **and** Piano Proficiencies. The exam will consist of a ten-minute recital in the student's principal performing area. For all voice concentrations, the program must be performed from memory. Other majors and concentrations should consult their applied instructor regarding memorization requirements.

Instrumentalists must submit an unedited recording of the 12 major and 12 natural minor scales with arpeggios to the instrumental coordinator during week 10 of the semester they intend to do their Upper-Level Exam. If the scales are not passed in week 10, then another recording may be

made in week 12. If the scales are not passed in week 12, then the student will fail their Upper-Level Exam and be required to attempt it again the next semester.

**FAILURE TO COMPLETE ALL COMPONENTS OF THE UPPER-LEVEL EXAM MEANS THAT STUDENTS MAY NOT REGISTER FOR UPPER-LEVEL MUSIC COURSES UNTIL ALL COMPONENTS OF THE EXAM ARE SUCCESSFULLY COMPLETED.**

Students must register for applied music at the sophomore level until the Upper-Level Exam is successfully completed.

Transfer students will be permitted to enroll in Upper-Level coursework, including applied study, in their first semester at Carey provided they meet the following criteria: 1) have earned the equivalent of two full years of credit (freshman and sophomore) in their applied concentration, 2) have earned credit for freshman and sophomore music theory, and 3) have completed or made significant progress toward completion of all requirements for the piano proficiency as determined by the Carey music faculty.

To continue in Upper-Level coursework beyond the first semester at Carey, transfer students meeting the criteria above must successfully complete the Upper-Level exam and piano proficiency by the end of the first semester. Failure to complete both requirements will result in the student being restricted from enrolling in additional Upper-Level coursework until those requirements have been satisfied. With applied faculty approval, a transfer student's Upper-Level program may consist in part of previously prepared material, but not entirely.

## **SECONDARY PROFICIENCY EXAMINATIONS**

---

All students pursuing a Bachelor of Music, a Bachelor of Arts in Music, or a Bachelor of Science in Music degree **must pass ALL COMPONENTS OF THE UPPER-LEVEL EXAM.**

All music majors are required to have an applied secondary. For many music majors, this will be piano, as all students are required to demonstrate proficiency on the keyboard according to NASM guidelines. Piano majors must enroll in another chosen secondary area of applied music and pass the corresponding proficiency examination. *Piano proficiency requirements are found in Section 5 of this handbook.*

Secondary exams consist of the following:

### **Voice**

- Sing from memory three contrasting songs with precise intonation, musical accuracy, expression, clear diction, and a sense of style. The three selections should include an English song or aria and two language selections.

### **Guitar**

- Play two intermediate-level pieces
- Sight read one piece from a chord chart (pop symbols or numbers)
- Play major and minor diatonic and pentatonic scales in each CAGED position

- Play major and minor triads and their inversions across the neck in adjacent string and spread string spacings
- Play all 7<sup>th</sup> chord qualities in drop 2 and drop 3 voicings

### **Orchestral/Band Instruments**

- Play two pieces of intermediate difficulty
- Play all major and minor scales
- Play all major and minor arpeggios
- Play a chromatic scale

## Section 4: Performance Standards

### APPLIED STUDY

---

A general music fee of \$60 is assessed per applied music course in the Business Office.

There are two types of applied lessons:

- **Non-Major** – for students who desire elective applied lessons or are taking applied lessons leading to a proficiency exam. These lessons are 30 minutes in length. (1-semester hour)
- **Major** – for Music Majors on their primary/principal voice part or instrument. These lessons are 60 minutes in length. (2-semester hours)

Every student enrolled in applied major lessons is required to perform in Recital Class each semester (see *Recital Class* performance requirements below).

Students are expected to participate in their individual studio recitals, classes, or chamber groups as assigned by their applied professor.

### PERFORMANCE ATTIRE

---

Appropriate performance attire is required for all public recitals, Recital Class performances, jury examinations, upper-level exams, and proficiency evaluations.

- Men: Slacks or dress trousers, button-down dress shirts, and dress shoes. Ties and suit jackets are strongly encouraged (required for degree recitals).
- Women: Dresses of appropriate length, skirts with professional blouses, or tailored dress pants outfits with dress shoes.
- Prohibited Attire: Denim/jeans, t-shirts, athletic apparel, shorts, flip-flops, or athletic shoes are strictly prohibited for any formal performance evaluation.

*Note: Ensembles may have separate attire requirements. When specified, those guidelines take priority.*

### RECITAL CLASS

---

Attendance at recitals and school concerts is considered an integral part of each student's development as both a performer and an informed listener. Recital Class students are required to attend 11-13 weekly Recital Class meetings and 7-9 outside performances (student recitals, faculty recitals, ensemble concerts, musicals, and operas presented or sponsored by the Winters School of Music and other pre-approved musical performances) for a total of 20 performances per semester.

Music majors and minors enrolled in applied study must register for MUR 000 (Recital Class). Students who are required to perform a senior recital will register for MUR 001 (Senior Recital Class) in the term the recital is to be performed. Failure to register for Recital Class may result in a

reduction of Talent Scholarship or Ensemble Award. A grade of “P” or “F” will be earned in the class.

Students who fail Recital Class for two semesters will forfeit \$500 from their Music Talent Scholarship or Ensemble Award; every additional semester that is failed will result in additional reduction of Talent Scholarship or Ensemble Award. Students are required to register for MUR 001 (Senior Recital Class) during their final semester on campus or during their residency semester.

Transfer students who have met recital requirements at their respective schools, but do not have transcript credit, may be required to secure a letter verifying recital attendance.

#### Recital Class Attendance

Students are responsible for logging their own attendance for each session. Staff and faculty are unable to grant retroactive credit for missed scans or forgotten sign-ins.

- Students must scan their student ID prior to 9:25 AM. If a scanner is offline, students must sign a physical attendance sheet available at the entrance.
- Performing on a recital does not automatically log attendance credit. Performers must scan in or sign the attendance sheet on the day of their performance to receive credit for the session.
- Check-in closes promptly at 9:25 AM. Arriving late, failing to check in, or leaving before dismissal will result in zero credit for that class meeting.

#### Recital Class Performance Requirements & Expectations

All students enrolled in applied major lessons must perform in Recital Class at least once per semester. Failure to meet this requirement will result in a failing grade for the term. Performances must feature the student as the primary soloist (with or without a collaborative pianist). Chamber ensembles do not satisfy this requirement. However, standard repertoire involving additional performers (such as a duet or trio) where the student remains the featured performer may be approved at the applied instructor's discretion. First-semester students may be exempted from performing during the first term at their applied instructor's discretion. Secondary and elective students are encouraged to participate as scheduling allows.

Performance dates and venues are assigned by applied faculty. Once assigned a slot by the applied teacher (verified by the music office), the student is responsible for submitting complete program details no later than **4:00 PM on the Wednesday preceding the Friday performance**. Late or incomplete submissions will result in forfeiture of the performance slot. [Click here to submit recital class program information.](#)

Program details must be submitted via the **RECITAL CLASS PROGRAM INFORMATION FORM** and include:

- Full Title of Piece (including movement numbers and titles)
- Composer's Full Name and Dates (Birth–Death)
- Name of Collaborative Pianist (or note *Unaccompanied*)
- Exact Performance Duration (MM:SS)

*Note: Final performance order, times, and locations remain subject to change by the School of Music to accommodate collaborative piano scheduling and administrative requirements. Appropriate attire for all jury and recital evaluations must adhere to the Performance Attire requirements outlined in this section of the handbook.*

## **JURY REQUIREMENTS**

---

All students enrolled in major applied music are required to perform an Applied Jury Examination each semester. Repertoire and memorization requirements are contained in each applied course's syllabus. Each student will choose one piece, and the jury will request additional selections from the student's repertoire list. Performance majors should expect to perform several selections. All students must adhere to the Performance Attire standards outlined in this section.

Scale juries will take place in applied lessons during the student's weekly applied lesson in the following sequence:

- Fall freshmen – 12 major scales with arpeggios
- Spring freshmen – 12 natural minor scales with arpeggios
- Fall sophomore – 12 harmonic minor scales with arpeggios
- Spring sophomore – 12 melodic minor scales with arpeggios
- 

*Transfer student scale jury requirements will be determined by the applied faculty*

The final grade in applied music is determined by combining the jury grade with the professor's evaluation of the student performance throughout the semester. Grading criteria for all music courses is contained in the course syllabus.

Student failure to appear for a jury without PRIOR notice to the applied teacher will result in a jury grade of "F." Certain extenuating circumstances (i.e., death in the family, illness with doctor's excuse) may allow the student to receive an incomplete ("I"); however, a final semester grade may not be determined until the jury is complete. Failure to be present at a Jury, Upper-Level Exam, or Piano Proficiency Exam without PRIOR notification will result in an "F" in the applied lesson.

Since an incomplete ("I") is designed to accommodate the student unable to perform during the exam time, and not to excuse a student who is unprepared, the make-up jury should be completed by the end of the second week of the following semester. Students who fail to meet the jury make-up deadline will receive an "F" and must re-enroll and successfully pass the failed applied course. An incomplete ("I") which extends beyond the end of the following semester automatically becomes an "F."

## **JUNIOR/SENIOR RECITAL REQUIREMENTS**

---

Students in the following degree programs are required to present recitals:

- Music Education – senior recital of 25-30 minutes
- Performance – junior recital of 25-30 minutes and a senior recital of 45-55 minutes
- Music Therapy – junior recital of 25-30 minutes
- BA in Music – senior recital of 25-30 minutes

Students must complete the Upper-Level Exam before being allowed to present a junior recital. All required recitals must be performed prior to MUE 496 (Music Education) or MTH 497 (Music Therapy).

Non-degree recitals are encouraged. Scheduling will be based on availability.

#### Process for Scheduling a Junior/Senior Recital

In selecting and reserving a recital space, required degree recitals take precedence over non-degree recitals.

The recital date must be cleared with the applied teacher, advisor, and collaborative pianist (if applicable) before it can be reserved on the Music calendar. Dates must be scheduled in the Music Office. Students who do not perform a recital on the registered date will not be guaranteed a make-up recital date within that semester.

Please click the following link for the Recital Scheduling Form: [SCHEDULING FORM](#)

Degree recitals cannot be performed until the student passes a recital hearing with the applied music faculty at least two weeks prior to the scheduled date of the recital. Recital programs must be submitted to the Music Office at the time of the recital hearing. Students are responsible for setting up the recital space and cleaning up following a recital.

#### **COLLOQUIUM**

---

Students majoring in music education, performance, music therapy, or worship (leadership or technology) must participate in a colloquium course based on their degree plan. Participation will provide unique opportunities for interdisciplinary learning and shared development among students during various stages of their program. Students will discuss and address various techniques, methods, clinicals, and practical subjects related to their degree program to better prepare them for their field of study.

Enrollment in degree-specific colloquium courses is required until completion of all on-campus degree requirements. Colloquium meetings are scheduled 4-7 times per semester. Attendance is mandatory. There are four colloquium courses available:

- [Music Education Colloquium](#) (MUE 000) - required for all music education (vocal/instrumental) majors.
- [Music Performance Colloquium](#) (MUX 000) – required for all music performance (vocal/instrumental) majors.
- [Music Therapy Colloquium](#) (MTH 0010) - required for all music therapy majors.
- [Worship Colloquium](#) (MUC 000) – required for all worship leadership & worship technology majors and minors.

#### **COLLABORATIVE PIANO GUIDELINES FOR RECITALS/JURIES** *(for juries, recitals, etc.)*

---

The Fall 2026 Collaborative Contract is the required agreement to secure a pianist for lessons, juries, and recitals this semester. The contract must be filled out with the applied professor and submitted to Dr. Mathis by Thursday of Week 4 at 11:59 PM. All music must be uploaded as a single PDF in the correct key. Otherwise, the contract will not be accepted.

[Vocalists](#) may choose between two collaborative service options: Option A (\$400) provides one hour of services each week, while Option B (\$200) provides thirty minutes weekly. Both options include one general recital and jury. [Instrumentalists](#) who need a pianist have a single option (\$200) that will receive (6) 30-minute services over the course of the semester in addition to one general recital and jury. Links to both contracts are below.

If performing a degree recital, competition, or recording, there is an additional \$100 event fee that applies (this does not apply to Upper-Level or General Recital performances). Please note: all fees are non-refundable and must be repaid if an event is rescheduled.

Rehearsals can start as early as Week 5 and must be scheduled at least seven days in advance. Only two rehearsals per week are allowed during Weeks 12–14, and cancellations require at least 24 hours' notice to be rescheduled. Be on time and prepared. Missed or late rehearsals cannot be made up. By signing the contract, the student and the professor are agreeing to these policies, which are designed to help students stay organized and set up for a successful semester.

[Instrumental Collaborative Contract](#)

[Vocal Collaborative Contract](#)

## **GUEST ARTISTS**

---

Each year, the Winters School invites several US and international performers to present recitals in Thomas & Miriam Roberson Auditorium, Recital Hall, or Bass Chapel, sometimes preceded or followed by master classes the next day. These performances provide students with exposure to repertoire and opportunities to work with noted artists. Music majors are required to attend the recitals and participate in the master classes as assigned by applied faculty.

## Section 5: Piano Area Policies

All music majors at William Carey University are required to demonstrate keyboard competency, as is required by NASM (National Association of Schools of Music). The content covered in Freshman and Sophomore Piano classes provides a foundational knowledge of the piano to better equip a student for a successful career in music. Successfully passing four semesters of Piano Class (MUP 171, 172, 271, 272) with a grade of C or higher will complete the Piano Proficiency Exam and all the piano course requirements. All music majors must register and receive credit for completing the Piano Proficiency Exam (MUP 000). *If a student's primary instrument is piano, they must register for and complete a secondary proficiency exam before progressing to upper-level music study* (see Secondary Proficiency Exam requirements found in this handbook).

### **CLASS PIANO**

---

The Class Piano sequence must be completed in its entirety prior to passing an Upper-Level Jury, taking Junior and Senior Upper-Level courses, performing an academic Junior or Senior recital, completing student teaching, entering internships, and applying for graduation.

If the pace outlined by the piano classes is maintained, a student should complete the School of Music's piano requirements after four semesters (two as a freshman and two as a sophomore). Students are required to remain enrolled in piano continuously until the Piano Proficiency Exam is completed. If a student fails a section of class piano, the student must wait until it is offered again, then re-take it and pass it in order to progress through the class piano sequence.

### **TRANSFER STUDENT PIANO POLICY**

---

Transfer music majors and minors who have completed four semesters of class piano at another regionally accredited institution with a grade of B or higher are exempt from piano classes and the proficiency exam and must register for MUP 000 to receive credit. Those with two or three semesters of prior class piano with a B or higher must enroll in MUP 271 (Piano Class III), while students with one or zero semesters must enroll in MUP 171 (Piano Class I). Transfer students should complete the proficiency exam during the first term of their junior year at WCU and may take applied piano lessons as electives once class piano requirements are met.

### **PIANO PROFICIENCY EXAM**

---

The piano proficiency requirements are taught and tested in the context of Class Piano. Class Piano I and II develop fundamentals, while Class Piano III and IV work on the exam components. Students should register for the proficiency exam (MUP 000) concurrently with Class Piano IV. A student may attempt to pass components early at the discretion of the course instructor.

Piano proficiency exam components are as follows:

*Material covered in Class Piano III (typical sequence)*

- I-A. Solo Repertoire:** The student will prepare a solo piece that demonstrates overall competency in technique, phrasing, expressing, touch, use of pedal, and overall

- musicianship. One piece should be early-intermediate, and the other should be intermediate-advanced.
- II. **Scales / Arpeggios / Chord Progressions:** The student will prepare all 12 Major and Minor Scales, one octave; a “1-3-5-3-1” arpeggio, one octave; and the I – IV 4/6 – I – V 6/5 – I chord progression.
  - III. **Harmonization / Transposition:** The student will harmonize two simple melodies in the original key, using roman numerals or pop chord symbols as guides. Standard diatonic chords should be used in an appropriate accompaniment style. The melody is played in the right hand, and the accompaniment is played in the left hand. The student will then modulate with a pivot chord and transpose to a new key chosen by the student.
  - IV. **Accompanying:** This component consists of both written and improvised examples. The student will play an accompanying figure with both hands while the teacher plays or sings the melody. Evenness and continuity are to be emphasized. Folk, popular, or sacred music used by music educators, music therapists, and church musicians will be used.
    - A. **Written:** The student will perform two written accompanying examples while the teacher performs the melody.
    - B. **Improvised:** The student will perform two improvised accompanying examples while the teacher performs the melody.

*Material covered in Class Piano IV (typical sequence)*

- I-B. **Solo Repertoire:** The student will prepare a second solo piece that demonstrates overall competency in technique, phrasing, expressing, touch, use of pedal, and overall musicianship. One piece should be early-intermediate, and the other should be intermediate-advanced.
- V. **Hymn Playing:** The student will demonstrate the ability to perform two 4-part, contrasting hymns from a standard denominational hymnal. Appropriate use of pedal and continuity is required.
- VI. **Open Score Examples:** The student will demonstrate the ability to play all non-adjacent combinations of parts (ST; SB; AB) from a standard SATB open score example. The student should be able to switch parts in the middle of the piece. The student will also prepare and perform the SA and TB parts of a traditional closed choral vocal score.
- VII. **Sight Reading:** The student will demonstrate the ability to sight read two examples of at least a two-part texture with no advanced preparation.

## **PIANO PLACEMENT POLICY**

---

All freshmen students will automatically be enrolled in MUP 171 (Class Piano I) in their first semester. Music majors with a piano concentration will be enrolled in the piano major section of applied piano (MUP 111).

If a student has a significant background in piano and can demonstrate competency in some or all of the proficiency components, then the student may bypass some or all of the class piano requirements. The piano faculty will hold individual hearing times for such students. A student wishing to schedule a hearing should contact the Music Office and come to the hearing prepared to

demonstrate their level of comfort at the piano. *The piano faculty members reserve the right to determine whether a student should be placed in applied piano or in class piano.*

After the completion of the class piano sequence and the Piano Proficiency Exam, a student may continue taking applied piano, if desired. A student may NOT take applied piano as supplement to class piano (applied piano is not used as tutoring for the Piano Proficiency Exam).

Transfer music majors and minors who made a B or higher for four semesters of class piano at their previous institution will not be required to complete any piano classes or the piano proficiency exam. Transfer music majors and minors who have made a B or higher for two or three semesters of class piano must enroll in MUP 271 (Piano Class III). Transfer music majors and minors who have had one piano class or no piano at the college level must enroll in MUP 171 (Piano Class I). Transfer students may continue taking applied piano lessons as electives, if desired, upon the completion of class piano requirements.

All major and non-major applied piano students are required to complete a jury at the end of the semester. Specific jury requirements are decided by the applied instructor based on the course number and goals set in applied lessons.

*\*The piano faculty reserves the right to the appropriate course placement or applied piano placement of ALL music majors.\**

## Section 6: Ensembles & Performance Organizations

### **PRIMARY & SECONDARY ENSEMBLE REQUIREMENTS**

---

All music majors are required to participate in a primary ensemble based on their principal applied performance area each semester enrolled at William Carey University. To participate in secondary ensembles, students must maintain a minimum grade of "B" in their assigned primary ensemble. If a student's grade falls below a "B" at midterm, they are placed on ensemble probation for the rest of the term. If the student does not raise their primary ensemble grade to a "B" or higher by the end of the semester, or if they earn an "F" at any point, they lose eligibility for all secondary groups for the following term, are restricted to their primary ensemble, and forfeit any secondary ensemble scholarships. Students may regain eligibility for secondary ensembles once they complete a full semester in their primary ensemble with a grade of "B" or higher.

#### Primary Ensemble Assignment

- Vocal primaries:
  - o Vocal performance majors must audition for Chorale or Concert Choir and participate in one each semester until graduation.
  - o Worship leadership/technology majors are required to participate in Worship Choir and are highly encouraged to audition for Chorale or Concert Choir.
  - o Choral music education majors must audition for Chorale or Concert Choir and participate in one each semester until they enter their residency.
  - o Worship Choir is a co-requisite to Chorale and Concert Choir
- Instrumental primaries:
  - o All instrumental primaries are required to participate in either Orchestra, Piano Ensemble, Guitar Ensemble, Concert Band, Symphonic Winds, or Wind Symphony based on their primary instrument.
  - o All wind and percussion music education majors are required to participate in the Spirit of Carey until they enter their residency semester.
- Bachelor of Science majors are required to participate in at least 4 semesters of Worship Choir or Worship Band regardless of applied principal.

These requirements are for all students regardless of receiving a Talent Award. Each ensemble will have required performance attire. In most cases, this attire will be billed to the student's account.

### **PERFORMANCE ORGANIZATIONS**

---

#### Vocal Ensembles *(all vocalists in a vocal ensemble must be in Worship Choir)*

- Worship Choir – a choral ensemble that is open to all students; no audition required. All vocalists and vocal concentration music majors will participate in this ensemble. (variable credit)
- Chorale – the premier choral organization is open, by audition, to all students at William Carey University and performs the gamut of choral literature as well as extended works.

All choral education majors must audition for the Chorale until they enter their residency semester. (variable credit)

- Concert Choir – an SATB choral ensemble open to all WCU students by audition. This ensemble sings a variety of traditional and contemporary choral literature. (variable credit)
- Carey On – an auditioned chamber ensemble, members are required to audition for Chorale/Concert Choir. (variable credit)
- Carpenter's Wood – an auditioned, traveling worship ensemble that performs for churches and community events. (variable credit)
- Commissioner's Quartet – an auditioned male quartet. (variable credit)
- Musical Theatre Workshop – an ensemble that performs a variety of small- and large-form musical theatre literature. (credit)
- Opera Workshop – students audition and portray operatic roles in full-stage productions, one-act operas, or within studio settings with costumes, scenery, and make-up. (credit)
- Restoration Band – an auditioned, traveling worship ensemble that performs in churches, school chapels, and ministry conferences. (variable credit)
- Hub City Worship – an auditioned, traveling worship ensemble that performs in churches, school chapels, and ministry conferences. (variable credit)
- Cherry Street – an auditioned, traveling worship ensemble that primarily performs on campus, and occasionally in churches, school chapels, and ministry conferences. (variable credit)
- \*\*\*Other ensembles may be available that are not listed here.\*\*\*

**Instrumental Ensembles** (*all instrumentalists in an instrumental ensemble must be in Orchestra, Piano Ensemble, Guitar Ensemble, Concert Band, Symphonic Winds, or Wind Symphony based on their primary instrument*)

- Wind Symphony – the university's signature ensemble of woodwind, brass, and percussion instrumentalists. Acceptance and seating in the ensemble are by audition only. (variable credit)
- Symphonic Winds – the auditioned premier instrumental ensemble that performs appropriate literature for the ensemble and accompanies large-scale ensembles and productions. (variable credit)
- Concert Band – placement-based ensemble that performs appropriate literature and accompanies large-scale ensembles and productions. (variable credit)
- Carey Big Band – auditioned and placement-based jazz ensemble. (variable credit)
- Knights of Jazz – a small, auditioned jazz combo. (variable credit)
- Spirit of Carey – auditioned indoor marching ensemble. All wind and percussion concentration music education majors must participate in this group until they begin residency. (variable credit)
- William Carey University Orchestra – auditioned string ensemble. (variable credit)
- Carey String Quartet – auditioned string quartet. (variable credit)
- Pep Band – an ensemble selected from current large-format ensemble audition results that performs for basketball games in the winter semester. The maximum number of students in this group is 25. (variable credit)
- Pit Orchestra – an ensemble selected from current large-format ensemble audition results that performs for opera and musical theatre productions. (variable credit)

- Guitar Ensemble – a performance group that explores a wide range of musical genres from Renaissance to Contemporary utilizing pieces written for guitar ensemble or arrangements of appropriate works. Open to all students by audition. (variable credit)
- Piano Ensemble – an auditioned ensemble of pianists that performs literature for more than one piano. (variable credit)
- Thomas Hall – an auditioned rock guitar group that performs for campus, community, and regional events. (variable credit)
- Worship Band – an ensemble selected from wind auditions that performs with Worship Choir. (variable credit)
- \*\*\*Other ensembles may be available that are not listed here.\*\*\*

Music majors are required to register for the appropriate ensemble (based upon applied concentration) each semester enrolled as full-time students, even if the ensemble requirement has been met.

Worship majors must enroll in at least 4 semesters of Worship Choir or Worship Band regardless of concentration.

If the ensemble requirement has been met, the student may register for an ensemble for zero credit. Upper-level (300/400) ensemble course codes should be used for music majors and lower-level (100/200) course codes for non-major students.

## **MUSIC ORGANIZATIONS**

---

American Music Therapy Association – an organization for music therapy majors, AMTA provides opportunities for increasing knowledge concerning the field of music therapy and promotes opportunities and experiences for students in providing activities for persons with disabilities. Students are involved in opportunities at local, regional, and national levels.

Delta Omicron ( $\Delta O$ ) – a professional and honorary fraternity, DO is open to music majors and minors who achieve its required academic performance and professional standards. It provides opportunities to increase leadership, service, and performance skills.

NAfME – an organization for music education majors that provides opportunities for increasing knowledge concerning the field of music education. Students are involved in opportunities at the local, state, and national levels.

Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia ( $\Phi MA$ ) – an American collegiate professional and social fraternity for men with a special interest in music.

## **PERFORMANCE/AUDITION OPPORTUNITES**

---

NATS – the National Association of Teachers of Singing is a professional organization for instructors of voice. NATS provides an opportunity for pre-college or college students to audition and compete with students of similar proficiency and age. Regional auditions are held during the second week of November and state auditions are held the last weekend in March.

MMTA – the Mississippi Music Teachers Association is a professional organization affiliated with the Music Teachers National Association (MTNA). Membership is open to teachers and college students. Performance auditions are available in voice, piano, organ, guitar, strings, woodwinds, and brass areas at the annual state convention which is held the first Thursday, Friday, and Saturday of November at rotating locations.

## Section 7: Student Attendance & General Policies

### **CLASS ATTENDANCE**

---

Students are expected to attend class on time and adhere to each instructor's attendance policy that is contained in the course syllabus. According to school policy (**see the *University Catalog***), students must attend a minimum of 75% of class meetings to receive credit for the course.

Students in applied music courses are expected to attend all lessons and studio classes. In the event of an emergency or illness, students must notify applied instructors **prior** to the lesson. The collaborative pianist will be paid if scheduled to attend the lesson. Faculty will re-schedule lessons if they must miss a lesson. If a student misses more than three unexcused lessons, the student cannot pass the applied music course. Excused absences include extended illness with a doctor's excuse for each lesson or representation by the student in a School of Music ensemble.

Ensemble attendance is consistent among every group in the School of Music. A student is permitted one absence for sickness without a doctor's excuse as long as the student emails the director before the rehearsal. After one absence, a doctor's excuse or prior approval for a major life event is required.

### **FACILITIES & PRACTICE ROOM ACCESS**

---

School of Music buildings, including Thomas Fine Arts (TFA), Carey Band Hall (CBH), Lorena Roseberry-Smith Hall (LRS), and the College of Health Sciences (COHS), are open daily (see schedule below). Building access hours and building availability remain subject to change.

- Thomas Fine Arts & Carey Band Hall
  - o 6:00 AM -12:00 Midnight
- Lorena-Roseberry Smith Hall and College of Health Sciences
  - o 6:00 AM – 9:00 PM

Active student ID card scanning is required for entry into CBH, LRS, and COHS. Students must not prop open exterior doors or permit unauthorized individuals into facilities after hours.

Practice Rooms: Practice room spaces operate strictly on a first-come, first-served basis. Individual practice rooms cannot be reserved unless official School of Music signage is posted on the door.

### **ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE POLICY**

---

The use of artificial intelligence (AI) software to complete any part of a required academic assignment is prohibited unless explicitly permitted by the professor for that specific assignment.

At the Winters School of Music, professors may, at their discretion, allow the use of AI tools for certain assignments. However, students must assume that AI use is forbidden unless the professor

has provided clear, written permission. Violations will be handled according to the university's academic integrity policy.

## **NAXOS**

---

Music majors at WCU have access to the Naxos Music Listening Library online through the following address: NML URL: <http://WMCarey.NaxosMusicLibrary.com>.

## **SCHOLARSHIPS AND FINANCIAL AID**

---

All music students are eligible to receive scholarship awards based upon academic achievement, special talent, or commitment to full-time Christian service (CRV). Students must adhere to requirements outlined in the university's *Guide to Scholarships, Awards, and Grants* to maintain financial aid. Failure to maintain the required GPA or fulfillment of the Winters School of Music responsibilities could result in the loss of scholarship or award. Music majors must maintain a cumulative grade point average of 2.50 to retain their **Talent Scholarships and, when applicable, Ensemble Awards**. Students may **NOT** receive **Talent Scholarships** for more than five years. Exceptions may be applied for but will only be granted under circumstances deemed appropriate by the Dean of the School of Music.

When representing William Carey University, students should model the code of conduct from the student handbook. This includes refraining from public displays of affection and wearing clothing that represents other universities. Music students, as recipients of financial aid, are expected to represent the institution well.

## Section 8: Musician Health, Safety, & Wellness

### **INSTRUMENTAL INJURY PREVENTION & RESOURCES**

---

The term musculoskeletal refers not only to the muscles and skeletal structures of the body, but also the tendons, ligaments, nerves, blood vessels, and associated tissues. Although injuries to these structures are often considered in the context of athletics, they are also prevalent in activities and careers associated with musical performance. Common injuries of this type include carpal tunnel syndrome, tendonitis, and bursitis, among others. These can result from such things as: repetitive movements, poor posture, improper instrument carriage, insufficient rest, stress that inhibits relaxation, or excessive force. Such habits can lead to injuries that result in issues ranging from significant pain to career-ending conditions. Below is a list of signs and symptoms that may indicate a musculoskeletal injury:

- |                     |                  |                        |
|---------------------|------------------|------------------------|
| -Pain               | -Joint stiffness | -Loss of motor control |
| -Swelling           | -Redness         | -Numbness              |
| -Tingling sensation |                  |                        |

A close look at some specific injuries and how they manifest themselves may help us better evaluate personal playing habits.

**Tendonitis:** occurs when a tendon becomes inflamed due to overuse and friction resulting from repeated movements. Awkward posture and/or unnatural positions of joints can create friction, and the repeated action puts stress on the tendons. This condition can appear in players of a wide variety of instruments.

**Epicondylitis:** can come in different forms. The lateral form is also known as “tennis elbow,” while the medial form is known as “golfer’s elbow.” It can manifest as pain in the forearm, wrist, or elbow. It is often found in players who must use forearm rotation, and/or wrist bending with independent finger movement. Examples are keyboard, percussion, clarinet, harp, oboe, and trombone.

**Focal Dystonia:** occurs when a muscle in a specific location stops working properly. Some indications are difficulty playing, feeling fatigued in a specific location, cramping, involuntary joint movement, and loss of coordination. This condition can appear with or without pain. Typically, this condition is found in the hands and fingers of keyboard players and string players, the feet of drummers, and in the embouchure of brass players.

**Back and Neck:** these injuries often result from prolonged sitting or standing, as well as postures associated with supporting certain instruments (such as bassoon). Other causes related to body position are tilting or turning the head for long periods and “hunching” the shoulders. These actions and tendencies can cause unnatural spine position that may lead to bulging or herniated discs.

**Carpal Tunnel:** this condition is the result of nerve, tendon, and blood vessel compression and results in tingling, pain, and/or numbness in the thumb, index, and middle finger. Players who

require repetitive wrist flexion, along with a great deal of finger movement, are at risk. A variation of this known as cubital tunnel syndrome can occur at the elbow and result in similar symptoms in the two outside fingers.

These are a small sampling of the potential injuries facing instrumentalists. Given the complexity of the human body, an exhaustive list of possible physical issues is just not practical. Rather, the goal is to bring awareness and promote thinking regarding health and safety as a very real concern for instrumentalists. Understanding the possible dangers and being proactive about addressing them can help instrumentalists insure a long and healthy career. That begins with the individual taking responsibility for evaluating their playing from every perspective. It also means seeking and accepting the advice of instructors who may observe harmful tendencies in the physical aspects of your performance. Remember that, as musicians, we are working toward a performance that will best represent what we want to share with the listener. All the habits that lead to injury work against that effort. Addressing those characteristics that lead to inefficiency and tension will result in better performances.

### **Steps to help prevent injury:**

1. Stay relaxed! Avoid sustained tension in muscles and joints. This may require an adjustment to grip head/back angle, etc.
2. Warm up! It would be foolish for an Olympic sprinter to attempt the 100-meter without adequate stretching and jogging beforehand. It is equally foolish for instrumentalists to skip a warm-up. Don't just warm-up the embouchure, warm-up the large muscle groups with some quick stretching and motion. Also, loosen the neck, wrist, fingers, and shoulders as well.
3. Rest! Throughout the practice, take short breaks to stretch and relax the body. If you plan to practice more than 45 minutes to an hour, break the time up into multiple sessions during the day. 1 ½ hours of practice will not be as beneficial as two 45-minute sessions.
4. Don't force! If your body is telling you that you are overdoing it ... you are!
5. Plan ahead! If you know you have a big performance coming up, don't "cram" at the last minute. Your body will not be prepared for the sudden strain. Gradually increase your practice time and intensity starting well in advance. This will allow you to build the muscles up safely.
6. Evaluate! Ask yourself if there are other activities you participate in that are leading to discomfort when you play your instrument. This may require a change.
7. Lift properly! When moving equipment, avoid awkward positions.
8. Don't ignore! If you think you may have injured yourself, get medical advice/attention immediately. This could be the difference in the length of your career.

As with most injury prevention, most of the responsibility lies with the individual choosing to take precautions in his/her daily activities. The role of the school of music is to make students and faculty aware of the dangers associated with the field, provide suggestions on how to avoid injury, and refer individuals to medical professionals, if necessary, through personal referral or through the office of student support. The school of music is also charged with providing rehearsal and performance space that will permit a safe environment when utilized in an appropriate and responsible manner.

### **Resources Related to Musculoskeletal Health**

- National Association of Schools of Music (NASM) <http://nasm.art-accredit.org/>
- Performing Arts Medicine Association (PAMA) <http://www.artsmed.org/index/html>
- PAMA Bibliography (search tool) <http://www.artsmed.org/bibliography.html>
- Part 1: Introduction and Background. Preventing Musculoskeletal Injury (MSI) for Musicians and Dancers: A Resource Guide <http://www.shape.bc.ca/resources/pdf/part1.pdf>
- Part 2: Musicians. Preventing Musculoskeletal Injury (MSI) for Musicians and Dancers: A Resource Guide <http://www.shape.be.ca/resources/pdf/part2.pdf>
- Daum, M.C. Musculoskeletal problems in musicians. Center for safety in the arts. <http://www.sierranevada.edu/life/safety/musicsaf.html>

## **VOCAL INJURY PREVENTION & RESOURCES**

---

Vocal health is not only important for singers, but it is crucial for anyone who uses their voice for their profession, such as teachers, clergy, salespeople, lawyers, and counselors. Below are examples of issues or problems one can have with their voice and some strategies that may help mitigate them.

Colds, Sore Throats, and Laryngitis: viruses that cause the vocal folds to become inflamed. Your voice may sound hoarse, deeper than usual, and you may not have access to your high register. Your vocal folds are especially susceptible to damage when you are sick with an upper respiratory infection. Avoid using your voice as much as possible, avoid throat clearing, talk quietly if you must talk, rest, and hydrate.

Fatigue (muscle fatigue and tissue fatigue): when the voice is overused and can feel like a tight or sharp pain in the throat area. Tissue fatigue is more like a raw or sore localized feeling right behind the Adam's Apple. If you have muscular fatigue, work with your vocal instructor or a vocologist for a more efficient, less effortful technique. If the fatigue is at the tissue level, work to improve vocal hygiene by removing vocal irritants, staying hydrated, and using good breath support.

Acid Reflux Disease/Gastro-esophageal Reflux Disease: when acid comes up from the stomach into the larynx and can damage the vocal tissues. Some people experience a sour taste in the mouth or have heartburn-like symptoms. While surgery or prescription drugs may be needed to treat the issue, the first step is to try not to eat or drink (aside from water) 2-3 hours before bedtime. Limit foods such as coffee, chocolate, spicy or fatty foods, carbonated drinks, and alcohol. Don't smoke. Try to eat smaller amounts of food throughout the day. Avoid clothing that is tight around the waist, such as tight belts or jeans. Remain upright immediately after eating. Use a pillow to elevate the head or raise the head of your bed so you are not completely flat when you sleep. You can also try acid-reducing agents, such as Pepcid AC, that are now available over the counter.

Vocal Nodule: a benign growth (kind of like a callus) usually on both sides of the vocal folds resulting from chronic vocal abuse.

Vocal Polyp: usually only on one side of the vocal fold often resulting from a traumatic incident to the vocal fold (like a bad sneeze or cough while sick) after a vocal hemorrhage (bleed) or mucosal tear.

**Steps to help prevent injury:**

1. Listen to your body! You and only you know how you feel. If you notice you are having to strain or push your voice, take a break. If you notice you are tired or hoarse, rest the voice.
2. Warm-up! Warm up the midrange of the voice before the extremes. Use lip trills, singing through a straw, or other semi-occluded exercise (SOVT) to both warm up the voice and soothe a tired voice. And don't just warm up the voice – warm up and stretch the entire body (especially the neck, shoulders, and back).
3. Rest! Throughout your practices and rehearsals, take breaks to rest the voice and stretch and relax the body. Find ways to practice that don't involve the voice (mental practice, rhythm work, research/background information, diction work, etc.). Avoid whispering – that does not rest your voice.
4. Sleep! It is crucial that singers get enough sleep. General wear and tear on the voice and minor damage can often be remedied with adequate sleep.
5. Hydrate! Singers must stay well-hydrated to keep the surfaces of the vocal folds moist and functioning efficiently. Try to drink 64 ounces of water per day. Avoid alcohol, excessive caffeine, and other substances or foods that may irritate your voice.
6. Don't do drugs! Singers should avoid aspirin products. This includes any anti-inflammatory drug such as Aleve, Motrin, Advil, aspirin, etc. Vitamin E should be used in moderation. These agents thin the blood and could cause a vocal fold hemorrhage, particularly if combined with excessive or improper vocal usage. Tylenol is acceptable for the voice. Smoking and other recreational drugs are extremely detrimental to the vocal fold tissues. Note that some over-the-counter cold & flu medications and pain relievers can dehydrate the body.
7. Take a break! If you plan to practice more than 45 minutes to an hour, break the time up into multiple sessions throughout the day and practice silently for at least 5 minutes for every 40 minutes of active vocal use. Avoid singing for more than 2 hours a day, especially if you are still building your vocal technique.
8. Good posture! Use good posture/alignment and cultivate an efficient and free vocal technique.
9. Don't force! If your body is telling you that you are overdoing it ... you are!
10. Plan ahead! If you know you have a big performance coming up, don't "cram" at the last minute. Your body will not be prepared for the sudden strain. Gradually increase your practice time and intensity starting well in advance. This will allow you to build the muscles up safely.
11. Evaluate! Evaluate whether there are other activities you participate in that are leading to discomfort when you sing, such as talking too loudly, talking in noisy environments, repetitive throat clearing, shouting, cheering, singing or over-singing other genres of music, and general overuse.
12. Watch what you eat! Maintain a healthy diet and find positive ways to manage stress.
13. Don't ignore it! If you feel any vocal pain, immediately stop using your voice. If you suspect a vocal injury or have hoarseness or unintended voice change for more than two weeks, consult a medical professional. Your vocal instructor is trained to help you find the most potential from a healthy voice, not diagnose or rehabilitate an injured voice. As with most

injury prevention, the bulk of the responsibility lies with the individual choosing to take precautions in their daily activities. The role of the school of music is to make students and faculty aware of the dangers associated with the field, provide suggestions on how to avoid injury, and refer individuals to medical professionals, if necessary, through personal referral or through the office of student support.

### **Resources Related to Vocal Health**

The National Center for Voice and Speech <http://www.nevs.org>

National Association of Schools of Music (NASM) [https://nasm.arts-accredit.org/wp-content/uploads/sites/2/2016/02/6a\\_NASM\\_PAMA\\_NMH-Student\\_Information\\_Sheet-Standard-Vocal\\_June-2014.pdf](https://nasm.arts-accredit.org/wp-content/uploads/sites/2/2016/02/6a_NASM_PAMA_NMH-Student_Information_Sheet-Standard-Vocal_June-2014.pdf)

National Association of Teachers of Singing [https://www.nats.org/NATS\\_Wellness\\_Blog.html](https://www.nats.org/NATS_Wellness_Blog.html)

National Institute on Deafness and other Communication Disorders

<https://www.nidcd.nih.gov/health/taking-care-your-voice>

Vanderbilt Voice Center <https://www.vanderbilthealth.com/prgoram/voice-center#speech-language-pathologists>

### **HEARING HEALTH & NOISE EXPOSURE GUIDELINES**

---

One of the greatest risks for instrumentalists is hearing loss. Unlike the musculoskeletal issues that many musicians don't think much about, noise levels are something that we deal with on a regular basis. Many players fail to take necessary precautions to protect their hearing despite this awareness. It is important that we understand hearing health is not a concern only for those working around amplified instruments and music. It is a very real concern for all instrumentalists. This includes solo practice sessions in small spaces.

Beyond hearing loss, musicians face other career-threatening issues like tinnitus and pitch-perception problems. Tinnitus, often a ringing, buzzing, or hissing sound in one or both ears, is frequently caused by loud noise exposure. It can be temporary or permanent and is also linked to other health concerns like high blood pressure, highlighting the need for good overall health. Similarly, pitch-perception problems (the inability to correctly distinguish between pitches) can also result from damage due to loud noise exposure, which can effectively end a performing musician's career.

#### **A few facts about hearing and noise that will hopefully prompt thoughtful consideration:**

1. Hearing health is crucial for lifelong success in music.
2. Permanent hearing damage can result from exposure to loud noises. This is known as Noise Induced Hearing Loss (NIHL).
3. This damage is typically preventable by avoiding exposure to loud sounds, especially for long periods of time.
4. The closer you are to the source of a loud sound the higher the risk of damage.
5. The greatest risks come from sounds above 85dB in intensity (about the level of a typical vacuum cleaner).
6. Approximate exposure limits to sound are as follows:
  - a. 85dB (vacuum cleaner/MP3 player at 1/3 volume) = 8 hours

- b. 90dB (blender, hair dryer) = 2 hours
  - c. 94dB (MP3 player at ½ volume) = 1 hour
  - d. 100dB (MP3 player at full volume, lawnmower) = 15 minutes
  - e. 110dB (rock concert, power tools) = 2 minutes
  - f. 120dB (jet planes at takeoff) = without ear protection damage is almost immediate
- 7. Planning rehearsal and practice time to allow breaks from high volume material will help prevent damage.
  - 8. Use earplugs when you know you will be exposed to high levels.
  - 9. Don't limit your precautions to the music building/departments. Take precautions in every environment.
  - 10. Seek immediate medical advice/attention if you suspect you have suffered damage.
  - 11. If you have concerns about possible hearing damage in relation to your involvement in the school of music, speak with an instructor or director to discuss it

## Section 9: Faculty & Staff Directory

### LEADERSHIP

---

Brandon Hardin (Dean of the School of Music, worship studies)

B.M.E., Delta State University

M.M., Southern Oregon University

D.Ed.Min., The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary

[bhardin@wmcarey.edu](mailto:bhardin@wmcarey.edu)

Travis Coakley (Associate Dean of the School of Music, music education)

B.M.E., M.M.E., The University of Southern Mississippi

Ed.S., Auburn University

D.A., William Carey University

[tcoakley@wmcarey.edu](mailto:tcoakley@wmcarey.edu)

Will Bishop (Chair of Worship Studies)

B.M., The University of Memphis

M.M., Southwestern Baptist Theological Seminary

D.M.A., New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary

[wrbishop@wmcarey.edu](mailto:wrbishop@wmcarey.edu)

Joel Dunlap (Chair of Vocal and Keyboard Studies)

B.M.E., M.M.E., University of Mississippi

D.M.A., The University of Southern Mississippi

[jdunlap@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jdunlap@wmcarey.edu)

Cassandra Weiss (Chair of Graduate & Professional Studies)

B.M.E., M.M.E., University of Southern Mississippi

Ph.D., University of Southern Mississippi

[cweiss@wmcarey.edu](mailto:cweiss@wmcarey.edu)

### COORDINATORS

---

Jimi Brown (wind & percussion studies)

B.M.E., University of Southern Mississippi

M.M.E., William Carey University

[jwbrown@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jwbrown@wmcarey.edu)

David Bryan (guitar studies)

B.M., M.M., Southeast Louisiana University

[dbryan@wmcarey.edu](mailto:dbryan@wmcarey.edu)

Melanie Freeman (music therapy)

B.M., M.M.E., William Carey University

[mfreeman@wmcarey.edu](mailto:mfreeman@wmcarey.edu)

Jorge Gonzalez (string activities)  
B.M., M.M., D.M.A., The University of Southern Miss.  
[jgonzalez@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jgonzalez@wmcarey.edu)

Brian Murphy (piano studies)  
B.M., Mississippi College  
M.M., Mercer University  
D.M.A., The University of Southern Miss.  
[bmurphy@wmcarey.edu](mailto:bmurphy@wmcarey.edu)

Susan Ruggiero (vocal studies)  
B.M., Michigan State University  
M.M., University of Michigan  
D.M.A., Louisiana State University  
[sruggiero@wmcarey.edu](mailto:sruggiero@wmcarey.edu)

Ross Stark (media services)  
B.M., The University of Mississippi  
M.M.W.S., William Carey University  
[rstark@wmcarey.edu](mailto:rstark@wmcarey.edu)

Kevin Tharp (music education)  
B.M.E., M.A., Delta State University  
Ph.D., The University of Mississippi  
[ktharp@wmcarey.edu](mailto:ktharp@wmcarey.edu)

## **FACULTY**

---

Jessica Bryan (voice, music theory)  
B.M., M.M., Southeast Louisiana University  
[jbryan2@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jbryan2@wmcarey.edu)

Wes Cameron (music education, music theory, saxophone)  
B.M.E., M.M., University of Southern Miss.  
[wcameron@wmcarey.edu](mailto:wcameron@wmcarey.edu)

Katrina Cox (voice, musical theatre)  
B.M., William Carey University  
M.M., State University of New York  
D.M.A., University of Southern Mississippi  
[kcox@wmcarey.edu](mailto:kcox@wmcarey.edu)

Jeffrey Curtin (trumpet)  
B.M.A., University of Oklahoma  
M.M., University of Oklahoma  
D.M.A., University of Missouri-Kansas City

[jcurtin@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jcurtin@wmcarey.edu)

Anlan Deng (collaborative piano)  
B.F.A., M.M., Wuhan Conservatory of Music  
D.M.A., University of Southern Miss.  
[adeng@wmcarey.edu](mailto:adeng@wmcarey.edu)

Steven Dixon (tuba, euphonium, music theory)  
B.M.E., Jackson State University  
M.M., D.M.A., University of Southern Miss.  
[sdixon@wmcarey.edu](mailto:sdixon@wmcarey.edu)

Anna Dribus (piano)  
B.M.E., M.M.E., William Carey University  
[adribus@wmcarey.edu](mailto:adribus@wmcarey.edu)

Kyle Dykes (trombone, jazz studies)  
B.M.E., William Carey University  
M.M., Lee University  
[kdykes@wmcarey.edu](mailto:kdykes@wmcarey.edu)

Michelle Dykes (clarinet, voice, theory)  
B.S., The University of Southern Mississippi  
B.G.S., M.M.E., William Carey University  
[mdykes@wmcarey.edu](mailto:mdykes@wmcarey.edu)

Jon Fessenden (music therapy)  
B.A., George Washington University  
M.M., Brooklyn College  
M.A., Stony Brook University  
M.S., Molloy College  
Ph.D., Stony Brook University  
[jfessenden@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jfessenden@wmcarey.edu)

Zachary Harris (music education)  
B.M.E., Mississippi Valley State  
M.M.E., University of Mississippi  
[zharris@wmcarey.edu](mailto:zharris@wmcarey.edu)

Tae Young Hong (piano, theory)  
B.M., William Carey University  
M.M., The University of Southern Mississippi  
D.A., William Carey University  
[tyhong@wmcarey.edu](mailto:tyhong@wmcarey.edu)

Kaitlin Hosey (French horn)  
B.M.E., Western Michigan University

M.M., The University of Southern Mississippi  
[khosey@wmcarey.edu](mailto:khosey@wmcarey.edu)

Cameron Jenkins (music education)  
B.M., Alcorn State University  
M.M., University of Mississippi  
D.A., William Carey University  
[cjenkins@wmcarey.edu](mailto:cjenkins@wmcarey.edu)

Lindsey Keay (music education)  
B.M., University of Texas at Austin  
M.M., Ph.D., Univ. of Southern Mississippi  
[lkeay@wmcarey.edu](mailto:lkeay@wmcarey.edu)

Christina Mathis (piano)  
B.A., Judson College  
M.A.M.E., Liberty University  
D.M.A., The University of Southern Miss.  
[cmathis@wmcarey.edu](mailto:cmathis@wmcarey.edu)

Dewana Raulston (piano)  
B.M.E., University of Southern Mississippi  
M.M.E., William Carey University  
[draulston@wmcarey.edu](mailto:draulston@wmcarey.edu)

Vernon Whaley (worship studies)  
B.A., Welch College  
M.A., Middle Tennessee State University  
M.C.M., D.Min., Luther Rice Seminary  
Ph.D., University of Oklahoma  
D.W.S., Liberty University  
[vwhaley@wmcarey.edu](mailto:vwhaley@wmcarey.edu)

Cara Williams (voice)  
B.M., Southeastern Louisiana University  
M.M., Arizona State University  
D.M.A., Louisiana State University  
[cmwilliams@wmcarey.edu](mailto:cmwilliams@wmcarey.edu)

Quintus Wrighten (music education)  
B.M., University of South Carolina  
M.M.E., University of Southern Miss.  
D.M.A., University of Memphis  
[qwrighten@wmcarey.edu](mailto:qwrighten@wmcarey.edu)

## **STAFF**

---

Tanya Hobbie (administrative assistant)  
[thobbie@wmcarey.edu](mailto:thobbie@wmcarey.edu)

Jennifer Williams (administrative assistant)  
[jtwilliams@wmcarey.edu](mailto:jtwilliams@wmcarey.edu)

Meredith Owen (administrative assistant)  
[mkowen@wmcarey.edu](mailto:mkowen@wmcarey.edu)

Katie Rupert (coordinator of marketing & events)  
[krupert@wmcarey.edu](mailto:krupert@wmcarey.edu)

---

## **GRADUATE ASSISTANTS**

Charlie Byrd (worship studies - piano performance)  
Kendrick Davis (instrumental music education)  
Garret Johnston (instrumental music education)  
Benji Riley (worship studies - leadership)  
Kara Simon (choral music education)

---

## **ADJUNCT FACULTY**

Jim Armstrong (music education)  
Dr. Jason Beghtol (music education)  
Harold Bosarge (percussion)  
Dr. Samuel Dahmer (string bass)  
Richard DeLaFuente (percussion)  
Susan Dickey (music appreciation)  
Jessica Dykes (violin/viola)  
Jamie Howe (dance)  
Toney Keeler (choral music ed)  
Dylan Laird (worship studies)  
Dr. Jessica McMillan (music education, worship studies)  
Sarah Odom (music education)  
Dr. D.D. Pitts (music education)  
Makayla Rasmussen (double reeds)  
Dr. Mark Taylor (conducting)  
Kathy Vail (piano)  
Emilie Williams (worship studies)